

WHIDBEY ISLAND HORSE COUNCIL
MEETING MINUTES
11/5/2025

The meeting was called to order at 6:30 by coordinator Sally Garratt. Eight people were present. The meeting notes from the October meeting were read and approved.

The Mission Statement, as compiled by Leslie, was reviewed and commented on by those present. Several suggestions were made and the Mission statement as presented with minor changes was adopted by the members.

The Equine Economic impact survey was discussed. We have received responses from Skagit Farmers regarding the sale of products on the island to horse owners but that number does not include all of the horse related sales. Tractor Supply can give us numbers of aggregate spending on horse related products but that number also does not include all related sales. The committee will contact Heather McCoy at the Conservation District to see if we can partner with them to update the survey done by the District in 2015. The committee will also review the Agricultural census done in 2022 but that census related to agriculture not horses. Paula will talk to Paula Mott, the County Planner about the survey. Carol was added to the committee as a member.

Rhed reported that Thora Ivarson at the Coupeville Chamber of Commerce has almost completed the directory of horse related info. It is called the Island County Horse Directory and will be posted on the Whidbey Equine Network and the Island County webpage as well as other places. We discussed how to get the information out to anyone interested.

The Bell's Farm sale was discussed. Rhed and Karena met to discuss possible uses of the property for English disciplines including Pony Club, Events, and cross country. More discussion followed.

The next Horse Council meeting will be held on December 3rd at the Race Road Fire station at 6:30pm. The meeting was adjourned at 8pm.